

FOSS in Action

Preparing for that Crucial Meeting



The FOSS ecosystem gets richer by the day. A tool-based approach of looking at FOSS applications in isolation may not be as convincing as watching FOSS in action in an every-day office scenario.

The general tendency is to evaluate FOSS applications based on particular tools. This leads us to look at

FOSS tools in isolation and describe their functionality. The user scenarios are generally taken for granted or are implicitly assumed. This approach works fine most of the time. But when overdone, there is the danger of missing the forest for the trees. A use-case-based approach, on the other hand, allows us to set up a compelling context around the tool's usage and allows us to create a more demonstrative presentation for decision makers. Let us follow Aakash as he convinces his bosses about the superiority of a fairly unknown

FOSS tool, by actually demonstrating its capabilities when it was most required.

The background

Aakash's employer, OS² Systems, was a medium enterprise in the services business. It was important to make every penny count at OS² to stay profitable. Although he had other offers on hand, Aakash had been impressed by his employer's recruitment team on campus. "You will have all the freedom to experiment and try out new things to improve our productivity and profitability," the CTO on the recruitment team had told him. The FOSS aficionado that he was, Aakash saw this as an opportunity to put FOSS to work in a real corporate

Disclaimer: Any resemblance to real characters is purely coincidental and unintentional. The choice of desktop environments and applications mentioned is not meant to be prejudicial in any way. The situations are contrived for the sole purpose of effective communication. Finally, YMMV or your mileage may vary.